Teacher Compensation Tips and Tricks

Business Academy Group Learning · Teacher Compensation · March 2027

Competitive compensation helps you keep great teachers, and great teachers keep families. These tips help you plan pay you can afford.

Know your current picture

- **List total compensation.** Write down pay, benefits, and paid time for every role.
- **Compare locally.** Find out what nearby programs, schools, and retailers pay for similar hours.
- **Ask your staff.** Learn what matters most to them; it may not always be the paycheck.

Plan raises you can afford

- **Use the Budgeting Tool.** Price every raise or benefit as a scenario first.
- **Phase it in.** A planned raise each year can be easier to fund than one large jump.
- **Link to tuition.** If cost per child is higher than tuition, pay increases will need a pricing change.
- **Remember payroll costs.** Raises also increase payroll taxes and some benefit costs.

Build a simple pay scale

- **Set starting pay by role.** Assistant, teacher, lead teacher, director.
- **Add steps.** Planned increases for experience, credentials, or completed training.
- **Write it down.** A written scale makes pay fair and easy to explain.

Low-cost ways to show value

- **Paid planning time.** Even an hour a week shows respect for teaching work.
- **Predictable schedules.** Post schedules early and keep them steady.
- **Recognition.** Thank-you notes, shout-outs to families, and celebrating milestones.
- **Training on paid time.** Cover training hours and celebrate credentials.

Look for outside support

- **Ask about state programs.** Check with VDOE and your Business Specialist for current teacher incentive and wage support programs.
- **Use shared services.** The VSSN platform may offer group pricing on benefits and supplies.

Questions? Contact your Business Specialist: [name, email, phone]